

TUNISIAN BACCALAUREAT EXCELLENCE SERIES

Secondary Education — Year 4 — Skills for Life

UNIT 1: ART SHOWS AND HOLIDAYING

Chapter 7: At the Travel Agency

Welcome to the Premium Revision Booklet for Chapter 7! This document is engineered to serve as your ultimate companion for the English Baccalauréat Exam. Built upon the official Tunisian secondary curriculum (**Skills for Life**), this booklet integrates robust academic theory, comprehensive vocabulary guides, and flawless grammatical explanations. It also features a fully integrated 40-Flashcard active recall database, a mock examination evaluation, and visual aids including high-definition data charts and synthetic grammar boards.

- **Part 1: Exhaustive Course Theory** — Complete vocabulary portfolios, complaint communicative exponents, reported speech backshifting, and phonetic word stress classification.
- **Part 2: The Active Recall Repository** — 40 comprehensive exam-style questions & answers designed dynamically to avoid layout clipping and optimize revision.
- **Part 3: Evaluation Quiz & Summary Memos** — A diagnostic test containing QCM and True/False tasks with compulsory justifications, exhaustive feedback, and synthetic revision memos.

Baccalauréat Key Success Formula: Success in English depends not only on memorizing rules but on the tactical capacity to rewrite direct sentences into indirect ones (Reported Speech) and writing structured letters of complaint. Study this material systematically, test yourself by hiding columns, and victory is yours!

PART 1: THE EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1. Core Lexical Portfolio

To achieve a high-scoring rank in the Baccalauréat exam, mastering Lesson 7's core vocabulary and their exact definitions is compulsory. Study the table below systematically:

Vocabulary Item	Academic Definition	Bac Context / Example
Booking (n.) / To book (v.)	A reservation made in advance for a service or accommodation.	The tourist made a booking for a double room at the Hotel Superb.
Deposit (n.)	A sum of money paid as a first installment on a holiday or purchase.	Marion paid a 10% deposit to secure her flight and accommodation package.
Discount (n.)	A deduction from the usual cost of something; a price reduction.	Travel agencies offer a special discount for early-bird group bookings.
Refund (n. / v.)	A repayment of a sum of money returned to a dissatisfied customer.	Marion demanded a full refund because the hotel failed to deliver the promised services.
Scheduled (adj.)	Operating according to a fixed timetable or program.	We missed our scheduled flight because the airport transfer coach arrived late.
Disappointed (adj.)	Extremely sad or displeased because expectations were not fulfilled.	She was deeply disappointed by the sub-standard quality of the hotel food.
Superb (adj.)	Of the highest quality; grand, magnificent, or excellent.	The advertisement claimed the hotel offered a superb view of the sandy beach.
Oil Refinery (n.)	An industrial plant where crude oil is processed into useful products.	Instead of a quiet, pristine beach, the hotel room faced a noisy oil refinery.

2. Expressing Dissatisfaction & Complaining

In writing tasks (such as letters or emails of complaint to hotel managers or travel agents), the Tunisian Baccalauréat evaluates your ability to express deep dissatisfaction using polite yet firm formal language. Avoid informal slang and deploy these academic expressions:

Communicative Function	Formal Exponents / Academic Expressions	Real-World Application
Expressing Dissatisfaction	• I am writing to express my deep dissatisfaction with... • The quality of service fell far short of our expectations. • The reality was far from what was promised.	'I am writing to express my deep dissatisfaction with the standard of accommodation during our stay.'

Communicative Function	Formal Exponents / Academic Expressions	Real-World Application
Formulating a Complaint	- You explicitly stated/promised that... but in fact... - Contrary to your promotional brochure, we found... - We were led to believe that... whereas the truth was...	'You explicitly stated that every room had a sea view, but ours faced an industrial oil refinery.'
Demanding Action / Redress	- Under these circumstances, I feel entitled to a full refund. - I demand adequate financial compensation for the distress caused. - I look forward to your prompt response and settlement.	'Under these circumstances, I feel entitled to a full refund of my initial deposit.'

3. Grammar Mastery: Reported Speech in the Past (Backshifting)

When reporting what someone (such as a travel agent) said in the past, we must shift the tenses **one step backward**. The introductory verb (e.g., He said, she claimed, they promised) is in the past, triggering these mandatory transformations:

Direct Speech Tense	Reported Speech Shift	Direct Example	Indirect (Reported) Shift
Simple Present	Simple Past	"You'll love the food."	You said we would love the food.
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	"I am booking your holiday."	She said she was booking our holiday.
Simple Past	Past Perfect	"The hotel was nice."	He claimed that the hotel had been nice.
Present Perfect	Past Perfect	"I have paid the deposit."	Marion told him she had paid the deposit.
Will + Verb	Would + Verb	"You will be met at the airport."	They promised we would be met at the airport.
Can + Verb	Could + Verb	"You can see the beach."	The brochure said we could see the beach.
Must / Have to	Had to	"You must pay taxes."	The agent said we had to pay taxes.

Crucial Time & Place Transformations:

Direct Form	Indirect (Reported) Shift	Direct Form	Indirect (Reported) Shift
today	that day	yesterday	the day before / the previous day
tomorrow	the next / following day	now	then
here	there	this / these	that / those
ago	before	next week	the following week

4. High-Definition Visual Analysis

The following statistical graphic represents the direct outcomes of a customer satisfaction survey on 100 tourists who spent their summer at **Hotel Superb**. It clearly demonstrates why complaints are justified and serves as the visual database for writing exercises.

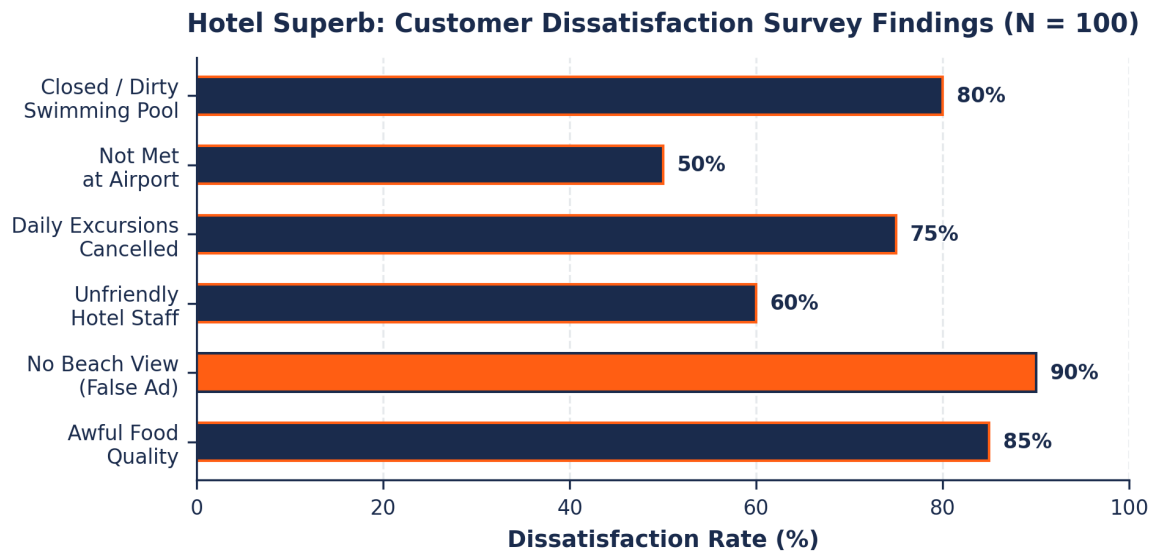


Figure 1.1: Statistical Breakdown of Tourist Complaints at Hotel Superb.

5. Phonetics: Word Stress Shifts (1st vs. 2nd Syllable)

The Baccalauréat pronunciation module tests your capacity to group words based on their primary stressed syllable. Chapter 7 introduces crucial bisyllabic and trisyllabic words related to travel. Review this phonetic classification:

Stress Pattern	Phonetic Stress Shift Key	Target Lexical Items & IPA Transcription
1st Syllable Stressed	The voice is raised on the first syllable. (Ooo or Oo)	• package /'pækɪdʒ/ • schedule /'fedʒu:l/ • travel /'trævl/ • discount (noun) /'diskaʊnt/
2nd Syllable Stressed	The voice is raised on the second syllable. (oOo or oO)	• deposit /dɪ'pɒzɪt/ • refinery /rɪ'faɪnəri/ • superb /su:'pɜ:b/ • refund (verb) /rɪ'fʌnd/ • opinion /ə'pɪnjən/

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY — 40 FLASHCARDS

This interactive section is custom-designed for rapid active self-testing. Cover the right-hand column and attempt to provide the detailed answer before revealing it.

No. & Examination Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q1: What does 'to book a holiday' mean?	It means to reserve flights, hotels, or holiday activities in advance through a travel agency or online platform.
Q2: What is a 'deposit' in travel agency terms?	A preliminary partial payment made by a traveler to secure a booking, which is usually non-refundable.
Q3: Define a 'package holiday'.	A pre-arranged vacation combining transport, accommodation, and sometimes meals/tours, sold at an inclusive, single price.
Q4: Explain the term 'scheduled flight'.	A flight operating according to a permanent, published timetable, regardless of passenger numbers (unlike charter flights).
Q5: What is a 'refund'?	The complete return of paid funds to a client, usually demanded after a severe failure in advertised service delivery.
Q6: What is an 'oil refinery' and why is it in this unit?	An industrial factory for refining oil. In Marion's story, her room overlooked an oil refinery instead of a beautiful sandy beach.
Q7: Define 'superb' in a travel context.	An adjective meaning of extremely high quality, magnificent, or breathtaking, used to describe scenery, service, or rooms.
Q8: Why was Marion extremely disappointed?	Because the travel agency failed to deliver almost every facility promised in their promotional advertisement.
Q9: What was wrong with the food at Saint Cuthbert?	The brochure promised she would love the food, but in reality, she described it as absolutely 'awful'.
Q10: What airport issue did Marion experience?	She was promised to be met at the airport by hotel staff, but nobody was there to welcome or assist her upon arrival.
Q11: Was Marion's hotel close to the beach?	No. The brochure claimed she could see the beach, but her window faced a noisy, polluting industrial oil refinery.
Q12: Why didn't Marion use the swimming pool?	Because the swimming pool was completely dirty, neglected, and closed for maintenance during her entire stay.
Q13: What did the travel agent offer as compensation?	The travel agent offered a 10% discount on Marion's next holiday booking as an apology.
Q14: Did Marion accept the travel agent's offer?	No, she rejected it completely, stating she would never travel with them again and demanded a full refund of her deposit.
Q15: How do we report 'will' in reported speech?	The modal 'will' shifts backward to 'would'. Example: 'You'll enjoy the scenery' becomes 'She said we would enjoy the scenery.'

No. & Examination Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q16: How does Simple Present shift in Reported Speech?	It shifts backward to the Simple Past. Example: 'I want a refund' becomes 'She said she wanted a refund.'
Q17: How does Present Perfect shift in Reported Speech?	It backshifts to the Past Perfect. Example: 'I have booked the room' becomes 'He stated he had booked the room.'
Q18: How does Simple Past shift in Reported Speech?	It backshifts to the Past Perfect. Example: 'We went to the beach' becomes 'They explained they had gone to the beach.'
Q19: How do we shift 'must' in Reported Speech?	The modal 'must' shifts to 'had to'. Example: 'You must pay now' becomes 'The agent told us we had to pay then.'
Q20: What does 'today' shift to in Reported Speech?	It transforms into 'that day' to reflect the shift in time perspective.

THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY (CONTINUED)

No. & Examination Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q21: What does 'tomorrow' transform into?	It transforms into 'the next day' or 'the following day' in reported speech.
Q22: What does 'yesterday' shift to?	It transforms into 'the day before' or 'the previous day'.
Q23: How does 'here' shift in Reported Speech?	It transforms into the spatial adverb 'there'.
Q24: Convert: 'I am leaving now' to Reported Speech.	He said that he was leaving then (shifting Present Continuous to Past Continuous and 'now' to 'then').
Q25: Convert: 'We paid a deposit last week'.	They explained that they had paid a deposit the previous week (Simple Past to Past Perfect, 'last week' to 'the previous week').
Q26: Identify the stressed syllable in 'package'.	The stress is on the first syllable: package /'pækɪdʒ/.
Q27: Identify the stressed syllable in 'deposit'.	The stress is on the second syllable: de posit /dɪ'pɒzɪt/.
Q28: Identify the stressed syllable in 'refinery'.	The stress is on the second syllable: re finery /rɪ'faɪnəri/.
Q29: Identify the stressed syllable in 'discount' (noun).	The stress is on the first syllable: discount /'dɪskaʊnt/.
Q30: Identify the stressed syllable in 'superb'.	The stress is on the second syllable: su perb /su:'pɜ:b/.
Q31: Identify the stressed syllable in 'schedule'.	The stress is on the first syllable: schedule /'ʃedju:l/.
Q32: Provide a formal expression to express dissatisfaction.	I am writing to express my profound dissatisfaction with the sub-standard service we received.
Q33: How do you politely but firmly demand a refund?	Under these circumstances, I feel strongly entitled to a full refund of our payment.
Q34: Convert: 'Every room has a shower' (direct complaint).	You said that every room had a shower, but ours did not have one.
Q35: Convert: 'You can see the beach from the hotel'.	You promised we could see the beach from the hotel, but our window faced an oil refinery.
Q36: What is the primary role of a travel agent?	A travel agent's role is to sell, package, and coordinate travel and accommodation services for clients.

No. & Examination Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q37: Define 'redundant' from Unit 1 Chapter 7 list.	Being dismissed from a job because your employer no longer needs you or your position has been eliminated.
Q38: What does the idiom 'to count your chickens before they hatch' warn against?	It warns against making plans based on assumptions that may not happen or counting on success too early.
Q39: Complete: 'She complained that she had been sitting...' (reported complaint).	...there for half an hour and that she would report it if it happened again.
Q40: Why is Reported Speech crucial for writing letters of complaint?	It allows you to contrast what the travel agent/brochure promised (Direct claims) with the actual poor reality (Indirect contrast).

PART 3: EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ

Diagnostic Examination Session: Attempt this mock exam under real Baccalauréat conditions. Answer all QCM items and justify the True/False statements meticulously before checking the solutions on the next page.

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions (Q1 - Q5)

Q1. Choose the correct Reported Speech conversion:

Direct Speech: "I have already paid the deposit," Marion said yesterday.

- A) Marion said yesterday that she paid the deposit yesterday.
- B) Marion told the agent the day before that she had already paid the deposit.
- C) Marion said the previous day that she had already paid the deposit.

Q2. Complete with the correct modal shift:

"We cannot swim because the pool is closed," the guests complained.

The guests complained that they _____ swim because the pool _____ closed.

- A) can't / had been
- B) could not / was
- C) would not / is

Q3. Identify the word with a different stress pattern from the others:

- A) deposit
- B) refinery
- C) discount

Q4. Complete the complaint politely:

Contrary to your brochure which promised we _____ at the airport, nobody was there.

- A) would be met
- B) will be met
- C) are met

Q5. A non-refundable amount of money paid to secure a booking is a:

- A) refund
- B) deposit
- C) discount

Section B: True or False with Justification (Q6 - Q10)

State whether the following claims are TRUE or FALSE and provide a mandatory grammatical or textual justification.

Q6. True or False: The word 'superb' is stressed on the first syllable just like 'package' and 'schedule'.

Q7. True or False: Marion accepted the 10% refund on her next holiday because she was a kind and forgiving person.

Q8. True or False: In reported speech, the direct adverb 'tomorrow' can remain 'tomorrow' if the introductory verb is 'said'.

Q9. True or False: The grammatical shift of 'must' in a past-reported sentence is 'musted'.

Q10. True or False: Marion's room had a superb beach view but the swimming pool was dirty.

EXAMINATION KEY: ULTRA-DETAILED CORRECTIONS

Section A Solution Keys

Q1 Correction: C — When transforming Marion's speech, 'yesterday' backshifts to 'the previous day' or 'the day before', and the Present Perfect 'have paid' backshifts to the Past Perfect 'had paid'. Thus, C is the only mathematically correct shift.

Q2 Correction: B — 'We cannot' shifts to 'they could not' because the modal 'can' backshifts to 'could'. The Simple Present 'is' backshifts to the Simple Past 'was'. Hence, B is the correct answer.

Q3 Correction: C — 'deposit' and 'refinery' are stressed on the 2nd syllable (**de**posit, refin**er**y). 'discount' is stressed on the 1st syllable (**dis**count). Therefore, C is the odd one out.

Q4 Correction: A — To report a future prediction made in a past brochure, 'will be met' (Future Passive) backshifts to 'would be met' (Conditional Passive). Thus, A is the correct answer.

Q5 Correction: B — A deposit is defined as the first installment paid to secure a holiday. A refund is money returned, and a discount is a price reduction. Thus, B is correct.

Section B Solution Keys (Justifications)

Q6 Solution: FALSE — 'Superb' is stressed on the **second** syllable (**superb** /su:'pɜ:b/), whereas 'package' (**pack**age) and 'schedule' (**sche**dule) are stressed on the first syllable.

Q7 Solution: FALSE — Marion categorically rejected the 10% compensation offer. She stated she would never use that travel agency again and insisted on a full refund of her money.

Q8 Solution: FALSE — If the reporting verb is in the past ('said'), 'tomorrow' must transform into 'the next day' or 'the following day' to maintain correct temporal perspective.

Q9 Solution: FALSE — The modal 'must' has no regular past form. It backshifts to 'had to' in reported speech. Example: 'You must check in' becomes 'The clerk said we had to check in.'

Q10 Solution: FALSE — Marion's room did NOT have a beach view; instead, it overlooked a noisy, polluting industrial oil refinery, which was a major cause of her complaint.

SUMMARY REVISION MEMOS

Memo 1.1: Complete Reported Speech Shift Matrix

Direct Speech Pattern	Reported Shift Rule	Example Direct Sentence	Example Reported Sentence
Simple Present	Simple Past	"I need a booking."	He said he needed a booking.
Simple Past / Present Perf.	Past Perfect	"I paid / have paid."	She stated she had paid .
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	"I am booking."	He told us he was booking .
Will / Can / May	Would / Could / Might	"You will / can go."	They claimed we would / could go.
Must / Have to	Had to	"You must leave."	She said we had to leave.
Imperatives	Infinitive with 'to'	"Wait here!"	The clerk told us to wait there.

Memo 1.2: Complaint Structure & Exponents

Use this formal structure when writing your Baccalauréat complaint essay:

Essay Section	Mandatory Purpose	Recommended Academic Sentence Starter
1. Introduction	State the reason for writing and identify the holiday booking details.	I am writing to express my profound dissatisfaction with the package holiday to Saint Cuthbert which we booked on...
2. Body Paragraph 1	Contrast expectations / promises with the actual sub-standard reality (use Reported Speech).	Although your promotional brochure explicitly stated that we would enjoy a superb sea view, we were shocked to find...
3. Body Paragraph 2	Detail further failures (e.g. food, unhelpful staff, dirty swimming pool, transport issues).	Furthermore, contrary to your written assurance that we would be met at the airport, we had to coordinate our own transfer...
4. Conclusion	Categorically demand compensation, refund of deposit, and outline next steps.	Consequently, I feel fully entitled to a full refund of my deposit, and I expect your prompt settlement within seven days...

Phonetic Stress Shift Tip: Always remember that nouns and verbs can have different stress patterns. For example, the noun **RE**fund is stressed on the 1st syllable, while the verb re**FUND** is stressed on the 2nd syllable. Make sure to mark this on your exam paper!